

Sean Finch

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Education

Northeastern University

September 2023 – May 2027

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Minor in Music

Boston, MA

Relevant Courses: Systems Security, Security of Wireless & Mobile Systems, Network Fundamentals, Network Security, Database Design, Cyberlaw, Computer Systems, Software Engineering, Intro to CS Research, Science Technology & Public Policy, Object-Oriented Design

Leadership & Activities: CTF Club, NU Choral Society (President), Alpha Phi Omega Co-ed Community Service Fraternity (President, Standards Chair, Service Committee), Cheese Club, NU Outdoors Club, Oasis Coding Club, Northeastern Electric Racing

Experience

Palo Alto Networks

June 2026 – September 2026

Security Engineer Intern

Santa Clara, CA

- Owned end-to-end design and implementation of Application Control Posture Check, a first-of-its-kind internal DAST compliance tool, cutting manual review from 3 hrs to 5 min; presented the model at a local OWASP chapter
- Engineered a modular, strictly-typed Python engine with pluggable auto-discovered rules, swappable identity providers (Okta, Idira) via a vendor-agnostic factory, and typed REST/SQL/DNS clients behind Pydantic boundaries, running daily GRC checks
- Automated 16 GRC controls across 10+ apps: SSO, privileged access, service accounts, X.509, DMARC (ISO 27001/NIST CSF)
- Exposed structured findings through a REST API to the risk dashboard, surfacing posture/control-drift to the CISO and Board
- Owned the risk dashboard's RBAC end-to-end (least-privilege); audited and remediated 10+ flaws including SQL injection

Neuralink

April 2026 – June 2026

Systems Engineer Intern (Security Operations)

Fremont, CA

- Overhauled endpoint, identity, and cloud security during rapid growth, earning executive buy-in for a dedicated security team
- Tested and deployed Microsoft Defender XDR and Sentinel (SIEM) across 500+ endpoints for alerting and incident response
- Managed the Intune MDM fleet across macOS and Windows, aligning device baselines to CIS Benchmarks and enforcing Conditional Access lockdowns, registration, and OS update rings that moved 20%+ of devices off outdated versions
- Automated provisioning with 10+ Terraform modules (IaC) and attribute-based Entra dynamic groups, auto-assigning 500+ users

Audax Group

May 2025 – April 2026

IT Operations Co-op (Security Operations)

Boston, MA

- Ran Nessus scans and vetted apps (permissions, network, posture), remediating findings and blocking risky software
- Hardened 700+ endpoints via configuration baselines in Entra ID aligned to CIS Benchmarks, boosting compliance by 35%
- Automated Autopilot provisioning (PowerShell scripts, Intune Win32), cutting imaging time 20%; briefed executives on impact

CENIC

May 2024 – August 2024

Cybersecurity Intern

La Mirada, CA

- Ran ~5 DDoS analyses/week on CalREN, safeguarding 20M+ students across all 12K+ public schools incl. CSU/UC systems
- Operated Tenable Nessus and Qualys vulnerability detection systems, using Python to automate scans and cut review time 50%
- Documented security processes and gathered KPI metrics, demonstrating improvements in response times and overall posture

Technical Skills

Cybersecurity & Compliance: Microsoft Defender XDR, Microsoft Sentinel, Tenable Nessus, Qualys, OpenVAS, Elastic SIEM, Kibana, Wazuh, Wireshark, Burp Suite, MITRE ATT&CK, CIS Benchmark, NIST CSF, Governance Risk & Compliance

Identity & Infrastructure: Okta, Entra ID, Active Directory, Intune, RBAC, SAML, OIDC, Terraform, CI/CD, GCP/BigQuery, Kubernetes, Docker, Nginx, Caddy, REST APIs, Git, Tailscale, Proxmox, TrueNAS SCALE, Linux

Languages & Development: Python, Go, Java, Kotlin, TypeScript, Bash, Powershell, C/C++, SQL, Pydantic, React.js, Node.js

Projects

[Homelab Infrastructure](#) | *TrueNAS SCALE, RAIDZ1, Proxmox, Kubernetes, Docker, Nginx*

- Built and maintain a production-grade home server on TrueNAS and Kubernetes, self-hosting 15+ services for 10+ users
- Deployed Wazuh (XDR/SIEM) agents on endpoints feeding a self-hosted manager to centralize logs, tune detections, and alert
- Scanned 15+ self-hosted services and 10+ endpoints continuously with OpenVAS, plus Pi-hole DNS filtering and monitoring
- Secured external access to self-hosted apps with Nginx reverse proxy, Tailscale (WireGuard mesh VPN), and identity-based access

Interests

Automotive performance, mountain biking, backpacking, street photography, strategy video games, choral singing, Romanian culture